

Word family: ****regain / regains / regained / regaining****

****Base word:** regain**

****Forms:** regains, regained, regaining**

****Part of speech:** verb (動詞)**

Your sentence:

> “Even now, it helps me clear my head and ****regain**** my focus.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****regain**** means ****to get back something that you previously had but temporarily lost****.

The speaker had lost concentration because of stress or distraction, and the library helps that concentration return.

****繁體中文： ** 重新獲得；恢復曾經擁有、但一度失去的東西或狀態****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “...it helps me clear my head and ****regain my focus****.”

「.....它仍然能幫助我整理思緒，重新****恢復專注力****。」

Here:

****regain focus = 重新找回 / 恢復原本失去的專注力****

1. ****regain = get back a quality, ability, or state (恢復) — 恢復；重新找回****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To recover a quality, ability, feeling, or mental/physical state that you had before but temporarily lost.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The library helps me ****regain**** my focus.”

「圖書館幫助我重新****恢復專注力****。」

Practice 2

> “She slowly ****regained**** her confidence.”

「她慢慢****重新找回了自信****。」

Practice 3

> “He stopped for a moment to ****regain**** his composure.”

「他停了一下，讓自己****恢復鎮定****。」

****regain = 某種能力、感覺或狀態一度失去後重新恢復****

Common:

- * regain confidence
- * regain focus
- * regain strength
- * regain composure
- * regain balance
- * regain control

2. ****regain = recover possession/control of something (重新取得) — 奪回；重新取得；收復****

****Regain**** can mean getting back possession, control, power, territory, or a position that was previously lost.

Practice 4

> “The team ****regained**** control of the game.”

「球隊重新****掌握了比賽控制權****。」

Practice 5

> “The army ****regained**** the territory.”

「軍隊****收復****了該片領土。」

****regain = 對原本屬於自己或曾經掌握的東西重新取得控制 / 擁有權****

Common:

- * regain control
- * regain power

- * regain possession
- * regain territory
- * regain the lead

This is a major concrete/institutional branch.

3. **regain = return to an earlier position/status (重新取得位置) — 重返 ; 重新取得**

Regain can refer to getting back a rank, lead, status, position, or advantage.

Practice 6

> “The player **regained** the lead in the final round.”

「那名選手在最後一輪重新**取得領先位置**。」

Practice 7

> “The company hopes to **regain** its market position.”

「公司希望重新**奪回市場地位**。」

regain = 重新回到之前擁有的地位、優勢或位置

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2.

4. **regain = recover consciousness (恢復意識) — 恢復知覺 ; 甦醒**

A very common fixed collocation is:

> **regain consciousness**

Practice 8

> “He **regained consciousness** a few minutes later.”

「幾分鐘後，他**恢復了意識 / 甦醒過來**。」

Practice 9

> “She had not yet **regained consciousness**.”

「她當時仍未**恢復知覺**。」

****regain consciousness = 昏迷或失去知覺後重新恢復意識****

This is an important medical/everyday construction, but semantically it belongs under Meaning 1:

> regain a lost state/ability.

5. ****regain = recover physical strength or health (身體) — 恢復體力 ; 恢復健康****

Practice 10

> “It took him several weeks to ****regain**** his strength.”

「他花了幾個星期才****恢復體力****。」

Practice 11

> “She gradually ****regained**** her mobility.”

「她逐漸****恢復了活動能力****。」

****regain = 身體能力、力量或功能失去後重新恢復****

Again, this belongs under Meaning 1 rather than forming a separate semantic core.

6. ****regain = recover trust/support/respect (抽象社會關係) — 挽回 ; 重新獲得****

****Regain**** can be used for abstract things such as trust, respect, support, credibility, or popularity.

Practice 12

> “The company is trying to ****regain**** public trust.”

「公司正努力****重新贏回 / 挽回****公眾信任。」

Practice 13

> “He worked hard to ****regain**** her respect.”

「他努力重新****贏回****她的尊重。」

****regain = 曾經擁有的信任、尊重、支持等失去後重新取得****

For strict counting, this remains under the broad ****get back what was lost**** concept.

7. ****regain ground = recover lost progress/advantage (固定表達) — 收復失地；追回失去的優勢****

Practice 14

> “The company has started to ****regain ground**** in the market.”

「公司開始在市場上****追回失去的優勢****。」

Practice 15

> “After falling behind, the team gradually ****regained ground****.”

「落後之後，球隊逐漸****追回差距****。」

****regain ground = 重新取得之前失去的進展、位置或優勢****

This can be literal or figurative.

8. ****regain one's footing/balance = 恢復平衡 / 站穩****

Practice 16

> “He slipped but quickly ****regained his balance****.”

「他滑了一下，但很快****恢復平衡****。」

Practice 17

> “After the shock, she needed time to ****regain her footing****.”

「受到衝擊後，她需要時間重新****站穩腳步 / 恢復穩定****。」

The second can be figurative:

****regain one's footing = 在混亂或困難後重新穩定下來****

Important distinction: **regain vs gain**

gain

= obtain something, whether or not you had it before

regain

= get something **back**

Compare:

> gain confidence

> = 建立 / 獲得自信

> regain confidence

> = **重新找回**曾經失去的自信

The prefix **re-** is crucial.

Important distinction: **regain vs recover**

These overlap strongly.

recover

can be intransitive:

> “He recovered quickly.”

「他很快康復。」

It can also mean get something back:

> recover lost data

regain

is normally transitive and emphasizes **getting a specific lost thing/state back**:

> regain strength

> regain control

> regain confidence

So:

> “She regained.”

usually sounds incomplete.

You normally need:

> “She regained her confidence.”

Important distinction: **regain vs restore**

regain

focuses on the person/thing **getting something back**.

restore

focuses on **bringing something back to its previous condition**.

Compare:

> “He regained his confidence.”

= 他重新找回自信。

> “The success restored his confidence.”

= 這次成功使他的自信恢復。

Different grammatical direction.

Important distinction: **regain vs retrieve**

retrieve

usually means go and get something back, especially a physical object or stored information.

regain

usually refers to:

- * control
- * confidence
- * strength
- * position
- * consciousness
- * trust

- > retrieve a lost file
- > regain control

Important distinction: ****regain vs recapture****

****recapture****

often means take back something by force or capture again.

It can also be figurative:

- > recapture the mood

****regain****

is broader and more neutral:

- > regain territory
- > regain confidence
- > regain consciousness

Important distinction: ****regain vs resume****

****resume****

means start an activity again after interruption.

****regain****

means get a lost state/quality/position back.

- > resume work
- > regain concentration

Not the same.

Grammar note: **regain is normally transitive**

You generally **regain something**.

Natural:

- > regain focus
- > regain control
- > regain strength
- > regain consciousness

Usually incomplete:

- > “I need to regain.” ❌

Instead:

- > “I need to regain my focus.”

Grammar note: **regain already contains the idea of “back”**

Avoid:

- > **regain back my confidence** ❌

because **regain** already means “get back.”

Use:

- > **regain my confidence** ✅

or:

- > **get my confidence back** ✅

This is a particularly useful learner point.

Related forms

The morphological family is unusually small:

* **regain**
* **regains**
* **regained**
* **regaining**

There is no common modern noun such as **regainment** in ordinary English.

Instead, English normally uses:

* recovery
* restoration
* return
* recapture

depending on context.

Under our family-sweep procedure, this is exactly the kind of family that should remain small rather than be artificially padded.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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regain — state/quality/ability	重新獲得一度失去的能力、感覺或狀態；恢復
regain — possession/control	重新取得失去的控制權、擁有權或權力
regain — position/advantage	重新取得之前失去的地位、領先或優勢
regain consciousness	失去知覺後恢復意識 / 甦醒
regain strength	生病、受傷或疲累後恢復體力
regain trust/respect	重新贏回一度失去的信任、尊重或支持
regain ground	收復失地；追回失去的進展或優勢
regain balance/footing	恢復平衡；重新站穩，亦可作比喻

For your original sentence

> “Even now, it helps me clear my head and **regain my focus**.”

The exact meaning is:

regain = 把因壓力、疲勞或分心而失去的專注力重新找回來

So:

> **regain my focus**

= **恢復我的專注力 / 重新集中精神**

For your database, **regain is semantically very unified**. I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings**:

1. **recover a lost state, quality, ability, feeling, trust, strength, consciousness, etc.**
2. **recover lost possession, control, position, territory, or advantage**

Most other uses—**regain focus, regain confidence, regain strength, regain consciousness, regain trust, regain the lead**—should be merged into those two branches rather than split merely because the object changes.